Ellie Yan

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Design Experience

Target — Senior Product Designer Jun 2024 – Present · Minneapolis, MN

- Spearheaded end-to-end web and mobile design and product launch for Digital Task Assignments, a 0→1 system bringing structured task management to 400k+ employees across 2,000 Target stores
- Accelerated iteration and interactive prototyping with AI, reducing discovery-to-delivery cycles from weeks to days
- Led generative and evaluative research with 50+ users across 10+ nationwide stores that drove roadmap and rollout decisions
- Rallied 10+ teams across engineering, product, and business around a shared long-term vision, establishing design as a trusted strategic leader
- Shipped customizable avatars for inclusivity and delight, modernized the label and signage printing tool, and designed a creator-economy concept to expand Target's reach with younger shoppers

Google — Product Design Extern Jan 2024 – Mar 2024 · New York, NY

- Drove design and product direction for Culture Walk, a Google Maps concept surfacing neighborhood cultural history along walking routes
- Developed high-fidelity prototypes for 3 interconnected flows: route discovery, AR wayfinding, and community-contributed archives
- Grounded design exploration in 4 ethnographic interviews, 49 survey responses, and competitive analysis of geolocative discovery products
- Presented final concept and product rationale to design leadership

Cornell Tech — HRI Research Intern May 2023 – Mar 2024 · New York, NY

- Designed data labeling, analysis, and experiments for 1000+ in-the-wild interactions between humans and garbage collection robots to identify behavioral patterns and socialization
- Built digital twins of 3 NYC locales to observe driver-pedestrian interactions in a controlled VR environment, informing the design of safe and culturally-aware autonomous vehicles
- Research presented at CHI 2024, Columbia Undergraduate CS and Data Science Fair, and Barnard Summer Research Institute

Skills

Interaction design · Rapid prototyping · User research · Design systems · Storytelling · Product management · Figma · Claude Code

Recognition

AmazonNext Design Challenge Dec 2024 – Feb 2025
1st place of 500 submissions

Upsilon Pi Epsilon 2022 – 2024
Computer Science Honors

Community

Guggenheim Museum × Barnard Sep 2024
Led 60-person workshop and critique of Jenny Holzer's "The Light Line"

Vagelos Computing Fellow Aug 2023 – Dec 2024
Peer academic leader supporting computational thinking, web development, and data privacy

Women in Computer Science Nov 2022 – Dec 2024
Secured $44k in sponsorship funding for Columbia's annual diversity hackathon

Education

Barnard College, Columbia University Aug 2021 – Dec 2024
B.A. Computer Science, Minor Psychology GPA 3.9/4.0